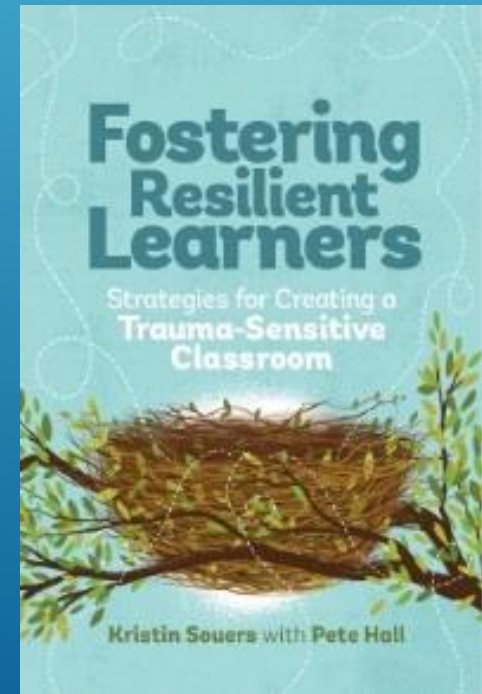


ACEs: Adverse Childhood Experiences and the Elementary School Classroom



SD148
Induction/Mentor Program



ACEs – Adverse Childhood Experiences

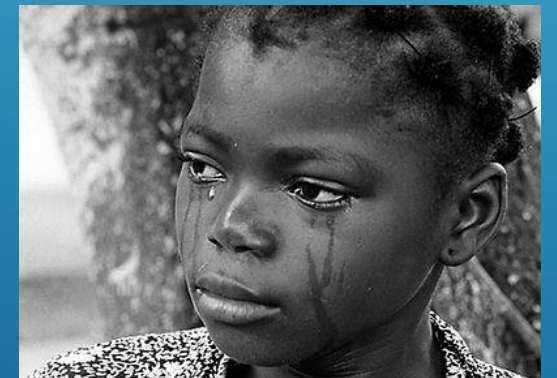
- Substance abuse in the home
- Parental separation or divorce
- Mental illness in the home
- Witness to domestic violence
- Suicidal household member
- Death of parent or loved one
- Parental incarceration
- Experience of abuse



Other ACEs

- Criminal behavior in the home
- Terminal or chronic illness of a family member
- Military deployment of a family member
- Exposure to natural disasters
- War exposure
- Homelessness
- Extensive bullying by others

Souers & Hall, p17



ACEs and Adults

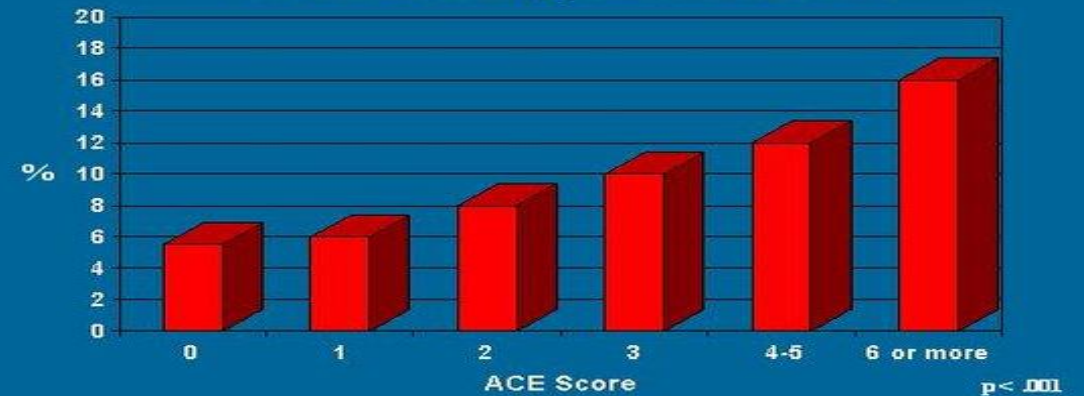
ACE Score and Indicators of Impaired Worker Performance



www.slideshare.net

Health Risks

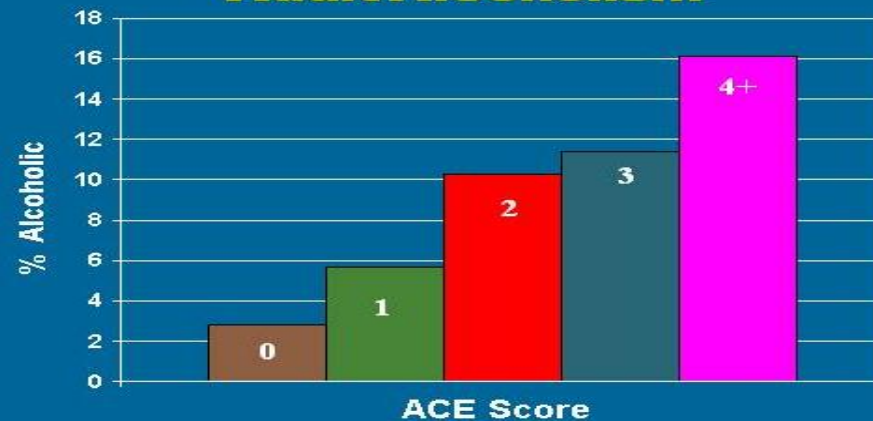
Adverse Childhood Experiences vs. Smoking as an Adult



acestoohigh.com

Health Risks

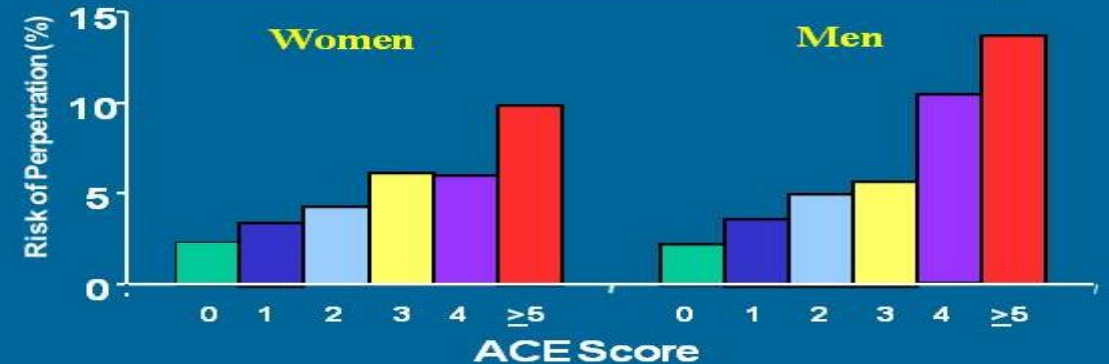
Childhood Experiences vs. Adult Alcoholism



acestoohigh.com

Socialfunction

ACE Score and the Risk of Perpetrating Domestic Violence



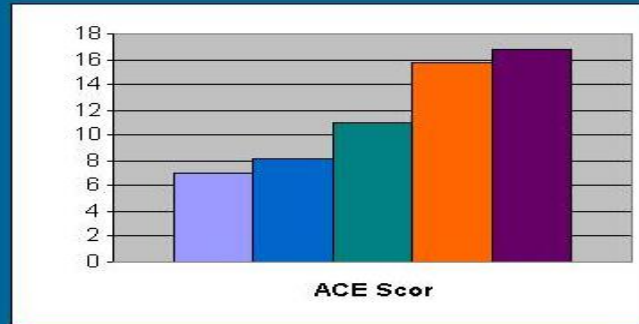
acestoohigh.com

ACEs and Adult Health

www.setinc.org

Biomedical Disease

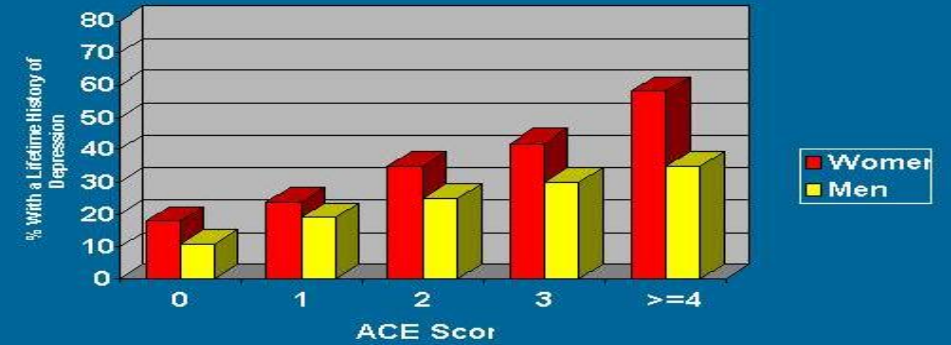
ACE Score vs. COPD



www.huffingtonpost.com

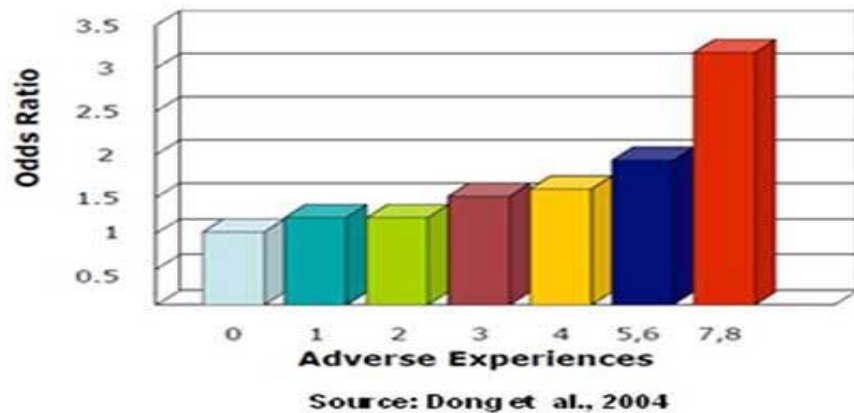
Mental Health

Childhood Experiences Underlie Chronic Depression



acestoohigh.com

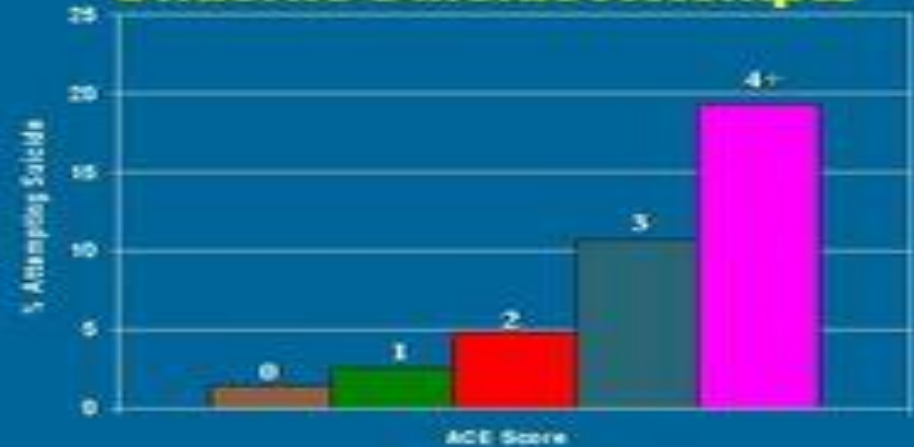
Risk of Adult Heart Disease Increases with more Adverse Childhood Experiences



childhoodtraumarecovery.com

Mental Health

Childhood Experiences Underlie Suicide Attempts



www.pinterest.com

ACEs and Adult Health

Probability of Outcomes

Given 100 American Adults

33 No ACEs	51 1-3 ACEs	16 4-8 ACEs
WITH 0 ACEs 1 in 16 smokes 1 in 69 are alcoholic 1 in 480 uses IV drugs 1 in 14 has heart disease 1 in 96 attempts suicide	WITH 3 ACEs 1 in 9 smokes 1 in 9 are alcoholic 1 in 43 uses IV drugs 1 in 7 has heart disease 1 in 10 attempts suicide	WITH 7+ ACEs 1 in 6 smokes 1 in 6 are alcoholic 1 in 30 use IV drugs 1 in 6 has heart disease 1 in 5 attempts suicide

www.iowaaces360.org

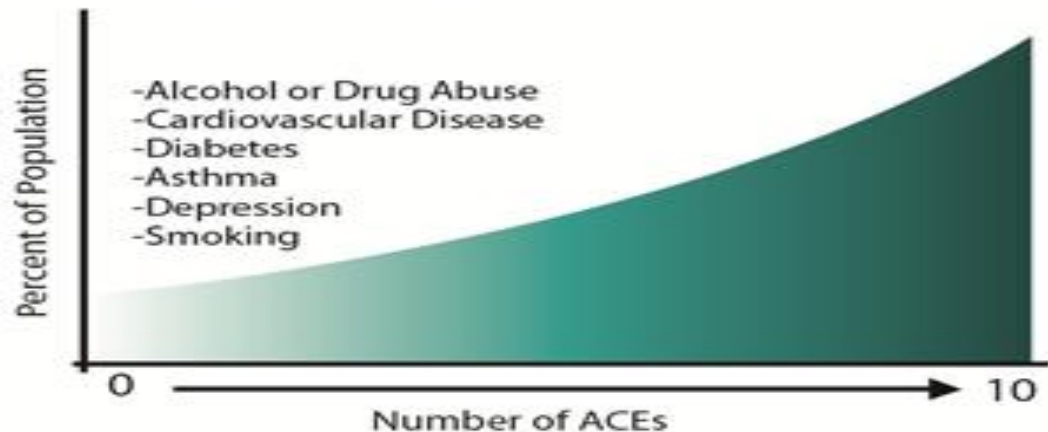
Mental Health: Costs

ACE Score and Rates of Antidepressant Prescriptions approximately 50 years later



acestoohigh.com

Effects of ACEs on Adult Health



www.setinc.org

ACE Score vs. Unintended Pregnancy or Elective Abortion

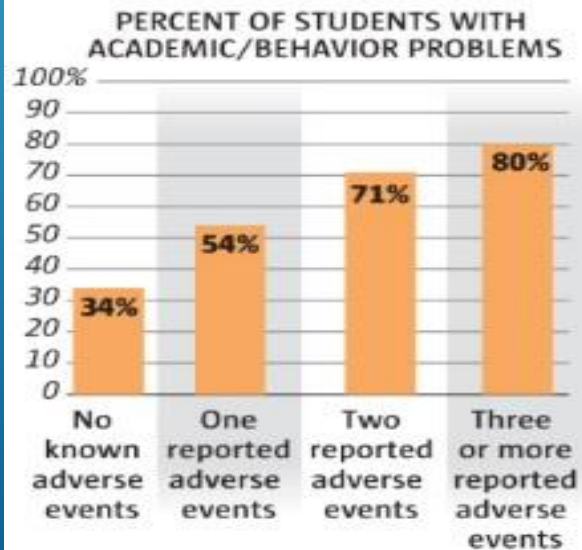


www.pinterest.com

ACEs and School

When ACEs rise, academics fall

A study of 2,100 elementary schoolchildren in Spokane makes clear the relationship between Adverse Childhood Experiences and problems in school.

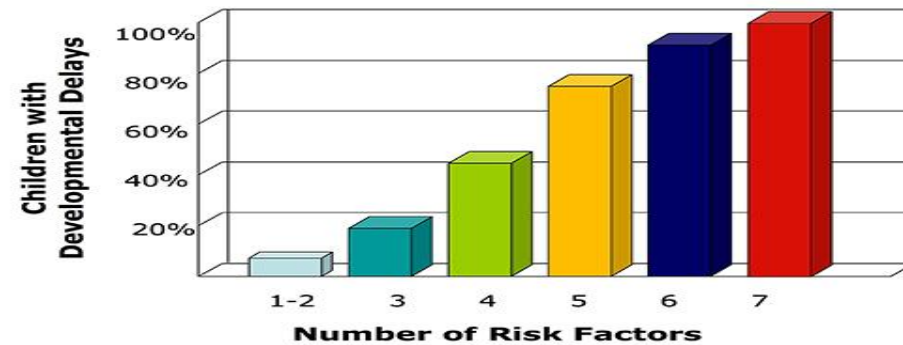


Source: Washington State University Area Health Project

MARK NOWLIN / THE SEATTLE TIMES

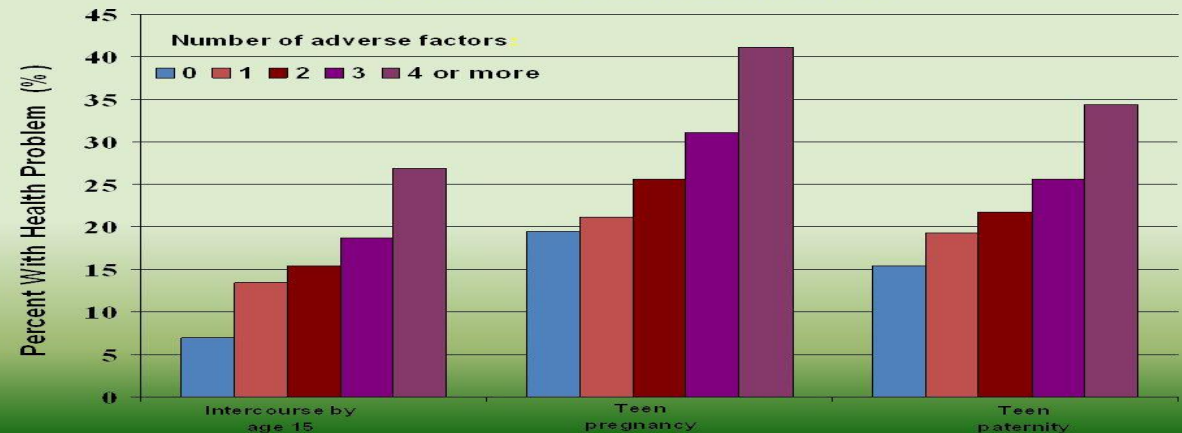
www.seattletimes.com

Significant Adversity Impairs Development in the First Three Years



developingchild.harvard.edu

Number of Adverse Childhood Experiences and Teen Sexual Behaviors



slideplayer.com

ACEs and School

	Attendance	Behavior	Coursework	Health
Zero ACEs	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0
1 ACE	2.2	2.4	1.5	2.3
2 ACEs	2.6	4.3	2.5	2.4
3+ ACEs	4.9	6.1	2.9	3.9

The numbers show the number of times a student with ACEs was more likely to have an issue.

Souers & Hall, p21

Ex: A student with two ACEs was 4.3 times more likely than was a student with zero ACEs to have a behavior issue

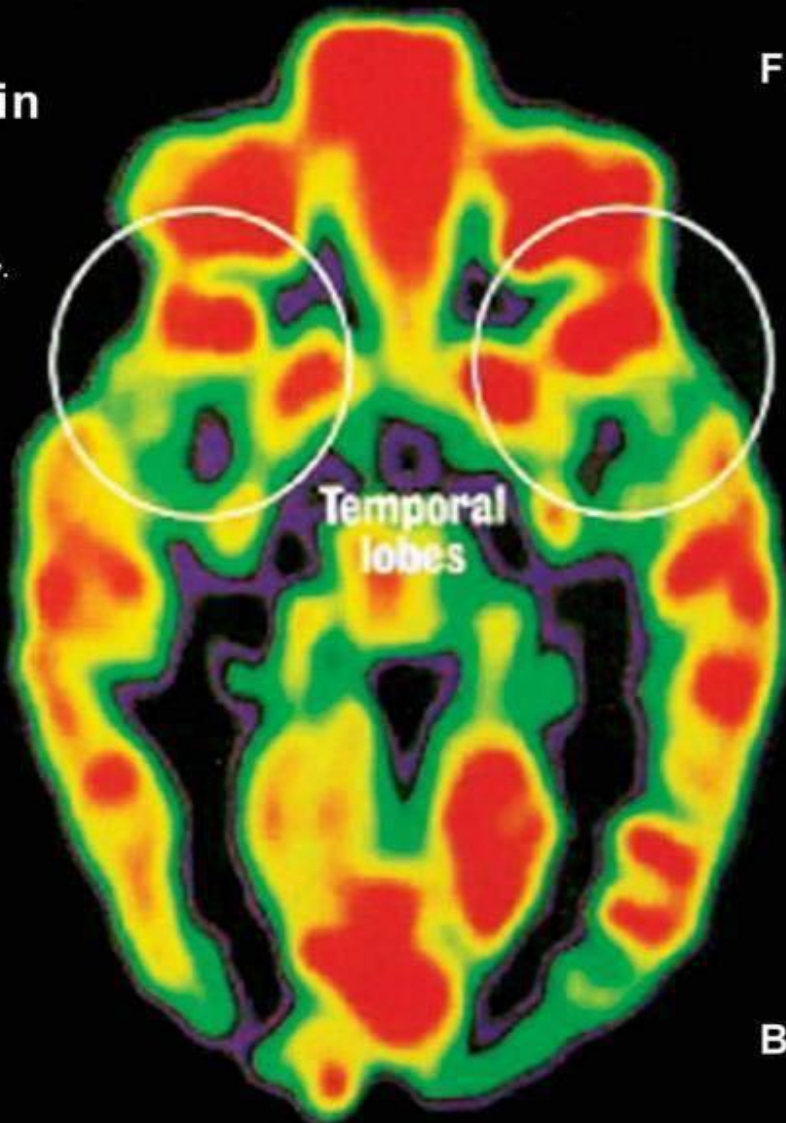
Ex: A group of 100 students with zero ACEs would have 10 students with behavior issues. A group of 100 students who have two ACEs would have 43 students with behavior issues



ACEs and the Brain

Healthy Brain

This PET scan of the brain of a normal child shows regions of high (red) and low (blue and black) activity. At birth, only primitive structures such as the brain stem (center) are fully functional; in regions like the temporal lobes (top), early childhood experiences wire the circuits.

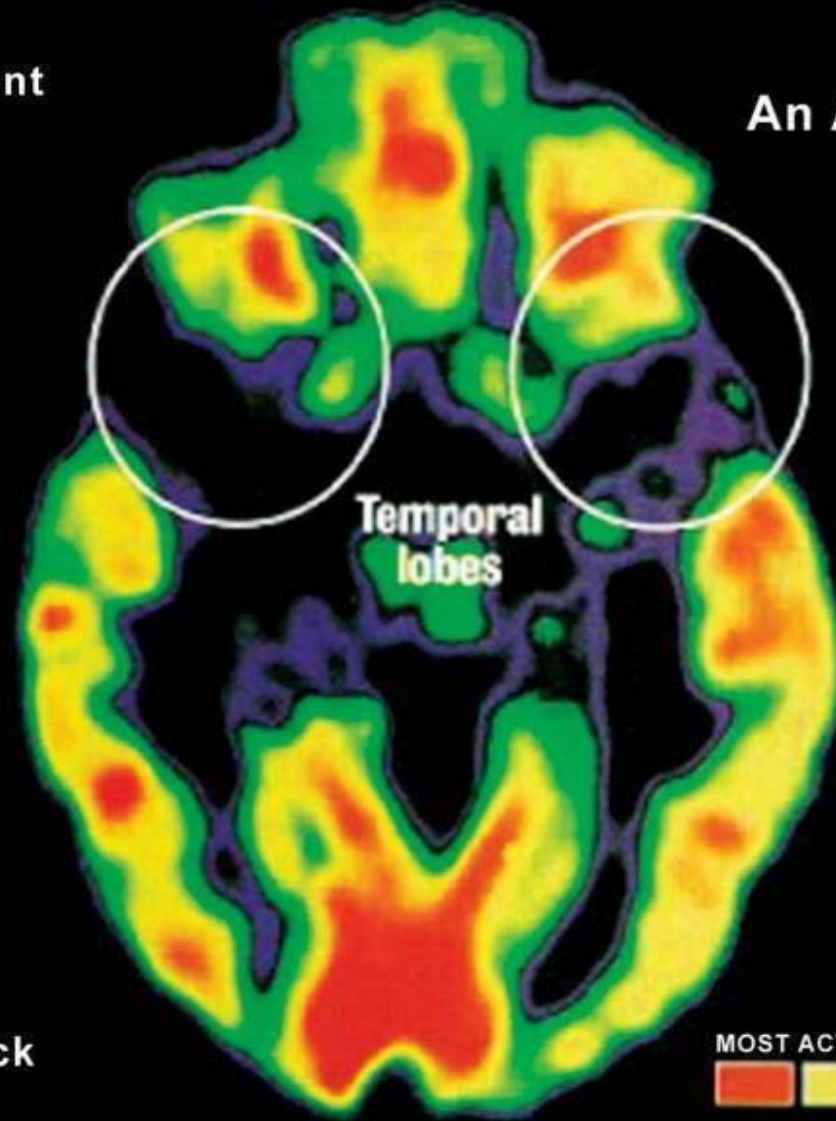


Front

Back

An Abused Brain

This PET scan of the brain of a Romanian Orphan, who was institutionalized shortly after birth, shows the effect of extreme deprivation in infancy. The temporal lobes (top), which regulate emotions and receive input from the senses, are nearly quiescent. Such children suffer emotional and cognitive problems.



MOST ACTIVE LEAST ACTIVE

Red	Yellow	Green	Black	White
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ACEs → STRESS → SURVIVAL MODE

What does it look like in the classroom?

Flight	Fight	Freeze
• Withdrawing • Fleeing the classroom • Skipping school • Daydreaming • Sleeping • Avoiding others • Hiding or Wandering • Becoming disengaged	• Acting out • Behaving aggressively • Acting silly • Exhibiting defiance • Being hyperactive • Arguing • Screaming/yelling	• Exhibiting numbness • Refusing to answer • Refusing to get needs met • Giving a blank look • Feeling unable to move or act

The Julie Scenario

Julie, a 6th grader at the Neighborhood School, is creating quite a ruckus in her 3rd period math class today. She came into the room scowling and has refused to take any notes or even open her book, and the teacher's request for her attention and eye contact are met only with deeper scowls. Julie has typically been disenchanted with math, and lately her behavior has been especially negative and uncooperative. As Julie's teacher, what would you do?



Responses to the Julie Scenario

- A. Offer her one more chance to get started on her work; after that, send her to the classroom next door. Her behavior is disruptive to the other students and must not continue like this.
- B. Invite her to come to your classroom at lunchtime to talk about math, school, life, or just to eat. Perhaps she'll open up about what's bothering her
- C. Send her to the office. You will not tolerate disrespectful behavior in your classroom. If she's not ready to learn, she doesn't need to be here.
- D. Leave her alone. Focus on your other students who are ready to learn. As long as she's not bothering anyone, she can sit there and scowl.
- E. Call a counselor to arrange a parent meeting. You need to get the parents on boards asap.

Thought Process

- A. This response demonstrates an expectation that Julie can pull herself together, although you won't extend that opportunity indefinitely. Eventually, you'll have to remove her so that she won't disrupt everyone else's learning
- B. This reflects a willingness to connect with Julie, to build a relationship, and help the person underneath the behaviors
- C. This demonstrates a mindset the Julie's behaviors require an immediate disciplinary consequence and that through discipline you can change her behaviors
- D. This demonstrates a low expectation for Julie's academic and personal growth and a belief that it isn't worth the time or the energy to connect Julie to the learning
- E. This indicates an understanding that Julie needs more help than you can provide in the classroom setting and that perhaps someone else can help you acquire that support.



Building Relationships

1. Wear concrete shoes
2. Watch out for tornados and stay out of Oz
3. When in doubt, close your mouth, and take a breath
4. It's not about you
5. Being available
6. Finding open windows
7. Giving grace

Souers & Hall Chpt. 3-14





**Forever changed,
not forever damaged**

Students are resilient!

